

# The First Home Buyer's 90-Day Checklist — Northern Territory

Everything you need to sort before you sign — the NT does this very differently.

Correct as at July 2026. Grant amounts and thresholds are set by government and can change — always confirm current details with the Territory Revenue Office ([treasury.nt.gov.au](https://treasury.nt.gov.au)) before relying on this for a purchase decision. This checklist is general information, not financial or legal advice.

## Section 1 — Understand the NT's Very Different Approach (Grants, Not Duty Relief)

- ☐ [ ] **Know the NT takes a fundamentally different approach to most other states.** The Northern Territory offers **no general first home buyer stamp duty exemption or concession** — you'll pay standard transfer duty rates unless a specific exemption applies (see below). Instead, the NT compensates with **Australia's most generous cash grants**.
- ☐ [ ] **Check your eligibility for the HomeGrown Territory Grant.** A **\$50,000** payment for eligible first home buyers **building or buying a new home**, with **no property price cap**, for contracts entered into before **30 September 2026** — confirm this deadline hasn't been extended or has closed by the time you're reading this.
- ☐ [ ] **Check the established-home grant separately.** A **\$10,000** grant was available for first home buyers purchasing an established home, but only for contracts signed between 1 October 2024 and 30 September 2025 — **this window has likely closed as at mid-to-late 2026; confirm current availability of any established-home support with the Territory Revenue Office.**
- ☐ [ ] **Understand the House and Land Package Exemption (HLPE).** This gives a **full stamp duty waiver** for eligible house-and-land packages purchased under a single contract from a registered builder, for contracts signed between 1 July 2022 and 30 June 2027, with **no property value cap**. This is not restricted to first home buyers, but is especially valuable if you're building.
- ☐ [ ] **Understand the FreshStart New Home Grant is for existing homeowners, not first home buyers.** It provides \$30,000 for existing owners purchasing or building a new home and isn't means-tested — relevant context if you're comparing NT schemes, but not something you'll access as a first home buyer.
- ☐ [ ] **Know you generally can't combine the HomeGrown Grant with the FreshStart Grant** — you can only receive one grant.
- ☐ [ ] **Check the federal First Home Guarantee** (5% deposit, no LMI) — confirm current NT price caps with a participating lender.
- ☐ [ ] **Get formal pre-approval, not just an estimate.**

## Section 2 — While You're Searching

- ☐ [ ] **Set a firm maximum price** based on your pre-approval — remember, unlike most states, there's no stamp duty saving cushioning an established-home purchase here.
- ☐ [ ] **Budget for full standard stamp duty on an established home purchase**, since the NT offers no general FHB duty concession — the NT's stamp duty uses a formula-based calculation for properties under \$525,000, and tiered flat rates above that.
- ☐ [ ] **Consider whether building (via the HLPE) could be significantly more cost-effective than buying established**, given the potential full duty waiver.
- ☐ [ ] **Budget for costs beyond the purchase price:** conveyancing fees, building and pest inspections, loan fees, and moving costs.

## Section 3 — Know Your Legal Protections Before You Sign

- ☐ [ ] **Understand the cooling-off period.** The NT offers **4 business days** from the final signature/exchange to withdraw — and unlike most other states, this typically comes **with no financial penalty** for changing your mind.
- ☐ [ ] **Know both parties can agree to extend, reduce, or waive the cooling-off period** — the NT's system is notably flexible here compared to other states' fixed statutory approaches.
- ☐ [ ] **Get a building and pest inspection done within your cooling-off window.**

## Section 4 — Between Signing and Settlement

- ☐ [ ] **Confirm building insurance timing with your conveyancer.**
- ☐ [ ] **Finalise unconditional loan approval** well before settlement.
- ☐ [ ] **Book a pre-settlement inspection** in the days before settlement.
- ☐ [ ] **Confirm your grant application is genuinely lodged and processing** — given the HomeGrown Grant's 30 September 2026 contract deadline, timing genuinely matters if you're purchasing close to this date.

## Section 5 — Common First-Home-Buyer Mistakes to Avoid

- ☐ [ ] **Don't assume there's a stamp duty exemption like other states have** — the NT's support model is grant-based, not duty-based, for general established-home purchases.
- ☐ [ ] **Don't miss the HomeGrown Grant contract deadline** — 30 September 2026, confirm this hasn't changed before relying on it.
- ☐ [ ] **Don't overlook the HLPE if you're building** — a full duty waiver on a house-and-land package can be worth tens of thousands of dollars.

## Quick Reference — Northern Territory First Home Buyer Support (July 2026)

| SUPPORT                   | AMOUNT / DETAIL        | APPLIES TO                                                 |
|---------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| HomeGrown Territory Grant | \$50,000, no price cap | New homes, contracts before 30 September 2026              |
| Established home grant    | \$10,000               | Contracts 1 Oct 2024–30 Sept 2025 — likely closed, confirm |

|                                         |                          |                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| House and Land Package Exemption (HLPE) | Full duty waiver, no cap | Single contract, registered builder, until 30 June 2027 |
| General FHB stamp duty exemption        | <b>None</b>              | NT is the only state/territory without one              |
| Cooling-off period                      | 4 business days          | Generally no penalty — flexible by agreement            |

Sources: Territory Revenue Office ([treasury.nt.gov.au](https://treasury.nt.gov.au)), [NT.GOV.AU](https://nt.gov.au). Always verify current figures and deadlines before making a purchase decision.

© HouseHQ. General information only, current as at the date shown, and does not constitute financial, legal or tax advice. Consult a qualified mortgage broker, conveyancer/solicitor, and the Territory Revenue Office before making decisions.

© HouseHQ. This document is licensed for the personal use of the purchaser only. Reproduction, resale, or redistribution of this checklist, in whole or in part, is prohibited without written permission from HouseHQ.  
**UNAUTHORISED DISTRIBUTION VOIDS ANY REFUND ENTITLEMENT AND MAY BREACH COPYRIGHT LAW.**